SOFTWARE ARCHITECTURE & CONSULTING DEPARTMENT

Architecture Review Checklist

Review standards for Stages 08-12 and 14

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Appendix J: Architecture Review Checklist

Project / document under review	
Reviewer (not the author)	
Date	
Outcome: Approved / Approved with conditions / Rejected	

Requirement coverage

- [ ] Every MUST requirement traced to design
- [ ] NFRs quantified
- [ ] Acceptance criteria exist

Architecture consistency

- [ ] Diagrams, ADRs and specs agree
- [ ] Terminology consistent
- [ ] C4 levels not mixed

Security boundaries

- [ ] Trust boundaries drawn
- [ ] Authentication and authorisation designed
- [ ] Secrets management defined
- [ ] Threat model reviewed

Data protection

- [ ] Data classified
- [ ] Encryption in transit and at rest decided
- [ ] Retention and deletion defined
- [ ] Privacy owner consulted

Scalability and performance

- [ ] Load model and targets
- [ ] Bottleneck identified
- [ ] Test plan

Availability and failure handling

- [ ] Single points of failure removed or accepted
- [ ] Timeouts, retries, idempotency
- [ ] Graceful degradation

Observability

- [ ] Logs, metrics, traces
- [ ] Alerts with owners
- [ ] Dashboards

Backup and recovery

- [ ] RPO/RTO defined
- [ ] Backups separate from primary
- [ ] Restore tested or test planned

Operational complexity

- [ ] Client can operate it
- [ ] Runbooks planned
- [ ] Support model defined

Cost

- [ ] Estimate has sources and dates
- [ ] Independent review
- [ ] Cost-control measures

Maintainability and vendor dependency

- [ ] Module boundaries clear
- [ ] Lock-in assessed with exit plan
- [ ] Technical debt visible

Implementation feasibility

- [ ] Skills available
- [ ] Timeline realistic
- [ ] Dependencies identified

Findings log

#	Finding	Severity (Critical/High/Med/Low)	Owner	Due	Resolution

RULE

No approval while a Critical or unaccepted High finding is open. Document accepted risks with the sponsor's name and date.